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July 25, 2026

Hiring Team

F_Trade_Fi

Re: Quantitative Trader — Prediction Markets

To the F_Trade_Fi team,

I will be as direct as your posting is. You asked for a verifiable live track record and a demonstrated edge. I do not have one in prediction markets. I am writing anyway, briefly, so you can decide in thirty seconds whether the rest is worth your time.

This summer I built and deployed an autonomous systematic trading platform end to end: an LLM decision agent, deterministic server-side risk gates, live OANDA v20 integration, streaming market data, PostgreSQL, and real-time monitoring, running against a practice account while I tested whether the strategies driving it had any edge at all.

They did not. I ran four pre-registered, out-of-sample tests spanning intraday signal models, a five-factor ensemble, and both time-series and cross-sectional carry across fourteen years of daily data. Every result came back statistically indistinguishable from zero. A conditional signal that scored 77% in-sample scored 15% out-of-sample. I published the finding rather than the fantasy.

What I think earns your attention is the next step. Before trusting those nulls I validated the instrument itself: the same backtesting engine, costs and financing charged, pointed at equity indices, recovered the equity risk premium at Sharpe 0.55. The zeros were readings, not malfunctions. Along the way I caught two production defects, including a multi-container state-divergence failure that was manufacturing phantom fills and quietly corrupting my own evaluation data, because I had architected graduated execution tiers that capped the cost of being wrong at under two dollars.

That is most of the list you published under a different name: execution quality, failure modes, drawdown discipline, and edge durability. What I do not have is six months of realized P&L on Polymarket or Kalshi, and I will not dress up a practice account as one.

So, plainly: if you need someone who already runs a profitable prediction-markets book, I am not that person today, and I would rather tell you now than waste an interview slot. If there is value in someone who builds the research, validation, and execution infrastructure such a book runs on, who has demonstrated he will kill his own thesis when the data says so, and who is working toward a live book of his own, I would welcome a conversation on those terms.

My background is twenty-three years as a U.S. Army officer, currently an information operations planner for the 3rd Infantry Division, finishing dual master's degrees in applied economics and applied analytics at Boston College. I have spent a career making decisions on incomplete information and defending them to people who ask hard questions. The platform, the code, the incident write-ups, and the findings are all public, and I am glad to walk through any part of them.

Respectfully,

David N. Belyn